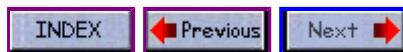


C Programming



UNIONS

This is a special data type which looks similar to a [structure](#), but is very different. The declaration is,

```
union mixed {
    char letter;
    float radian;
    int number;
};

union mixed all;
```

The first declaration consists of a union of type mixed, which consists of a char, float, or int variable. NOTE that it can be ONLY ONE of the variable types, they cannot coexist.

This is due to the provision of a single memory address which is used to store the largest variable, unlike the arrangement used for structures.

Thus the variable *all* can only be a character, a float or an integer at any one time. The C language keeps track of what *all* actually is at any given moment, but does not provide a check to prevent the programmer accessing it incorrectly.

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